



High-End Phone (₹35–50K)

Where performance, refinement and value meet the sweet spot

High-end phones in the Rs 35,000 – Rs 50,000 bracket have quietly become the new flagship killers. In 2025, this segment saw massive leaps in performance tuning, better thermal control, brighter and more colour-accurate displays, and camera systems that rivalled far more expensive devices. Brands also doubled down on long-term software support and efficiency, making these phones some of the most dependable all-rounders of the year.

Zero1 Winner: OnePlus 13R

The OnePlus 13R takes the top spot this year with the most balanced, refined and powerful high-end experience in its class. With its Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 chipset, it maintains smooth performance across heavy gaming, multitasking and AI-assisted features without throttling excessively. Its thermal design keeps temperatures in check even during prolonged workloads, making it one of the most stable performers in our testing.

The display is another highlight, a bright, colour-accurate 1.5K AMOLED panel with excellent HDR tuning and strong outdoor visibility. The camera setup, led by a high-resolution primary sensor, impressed with natural dynamic range, sharp details and reliable low-light results. Portrait separation and skin-tone accuracy were notably better than most devices in this segment.



iQOO Neo 10
Price: ₹33,990

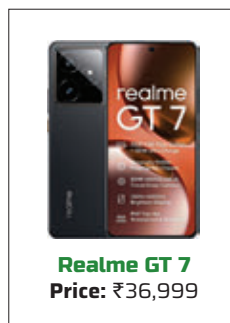


OnePlus 13R
Price: ₹39,999

Runner-up: Realme GT 7

The Realme GT 7 comes remarkably close, earning its runner-up position through raw performance and aggressive hardware tuning. Powered by the Dimensity 9400e chipset, the GT 7 delivered some of the strongest benchmark numbers in this category, along with exceptional snappiness in real-world use. Its flat AMOLED display is vibrant and responsive, making it great for gaming and media consumption.

The camera system leans more toward high-contrast, punchy output, which many users will enjoy, and its ultra-wide camera was better than expected in low-light scenarios. Thermals are controlled well, especially in longer gaming sessions.



Realme GT 7
Price: ₹36,999

Best Buy: iQOO Neo 10

The iQOO Neo 10 earns our Best Buy award by offering exceptional value without compromising on core flagship fundamentals. Its Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 chipset is efficient yet powerful, delivering consistently smooth performance backed by excellent thermal control.

Where the Neo 10 stands out is in reliability. The 50MP primary camera delivers clean, well-balanced images, the 6.78-inch smooth 144Hz AMOLED display is bright and fluid, and the 7000mAh battery provides a comfortably full day in full charge. 120W fast charging adds more convenience, while the build quality feels more premium than its price suggests.

For users who want the most complete all-round phone in the Rs 35,000 – Rs 50,000 range without overspending, the iQOO Neo 10 is easily the smartest purchase of the year.

— Yashraj Verma | editor@digit.in